Ishan Shah

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Engineering Manager & Hands-On Builder | AI-Powered Applications & Agent Engineering | Backend Systems & Team Leadership

SUMMARY

Hands-on engineering manager who builds AI-powered applications and leads the teams that ship them. Over 15+ years I've architected and shipped production AI agents and applications from scratch — multi-agent runtimes, retrieval/RAG, and MCP integrations — on deep backend and distributed-systems foundations (Python, API design, large-scale data services). I lead by example: still in code and architecture reviews, unblocking engineers, and making fast, high-quality calls in high-growth, fast-moving environments. I hire, grow, and retain strong engineers, partner closely with Product, Design, and AI counterparts, and bias toward simplicity, quality, and shipping user impact quickly.

EXPERIENCE

CruxOCM Inc. (AI startup) — Head of Automation (reporting to the CTO) · Feb 2025 – Present

- **AI-powered applications (0-to-1):** Architected and shipped production AI agents and applications from scratch on GCP ADK — miniBOT, a Gemini multi-agent troubleshooting assistant with RAG, and a test-authoring agent — defining and evolving the architecture for a fast-moving, AI-powered product.
- **Backend systems & scalable architecture:** Built the backend services, APIs, and retrieval pipelines underpinning these products — Kubernetes-based, 99.99% reliable, and scaling with the business; make the key architecture decisions and stay in code and architecture reviews.
- **Complex internal AI tools:** Shipped MCP servers (including a published open-source Lever MCP server) and AI-assisted developer workflows (Cursor, Claude Code, automated PR review) as internal tools that made the whole team more productive.
- **Ship fast, keep quality high:** Built a test platform with automated integration/E2E/regression and pipeline gating that cut manual regression from days to <12 hours — holding a high quality bar while the team moved quickly.
- **Hire, grow & lead:** Hire, grow, and retain engineers in a high-growth startup; set technical and team direction; foster a culture of simplicity and continuous improvement; and partner cross-functionally with the CEO/CTO and product/operations stakeholders to align engineering with company goals.

Insulet Corporation (connected medical-device product) — Sr. Cloud Engineering Manager · Dec 2022 – Feb 2025

- Led engineering teams (25–30 engineers) building the cloud/data-product platform and developer tooling for a connected medical-device product — hiring, growing, and coaching a high-performing team.
- Owned end-to-end delivery with automated testing and quality gating.
- Built backend performance and load-testing systems (Python, Locust, EKS) that improved product performance 25%.
- Automated build and release across ~25 backend microservices for a regulated product.

Amazon (AWS Redshift) — Lead Systems Engineer · Dec 2016 – Dec 2022

- Owned the build, CI/CD, release ecosystem, and test tooling for Redshift — one of AWS's largest-scale distributed data services — including the CI/CD servers and fully automated build/deploy across all AWS-supported regions.
- Led the team that designed and shipped a Bors-style automated merge queue, gating integration on the exact merge candidate (not just the feature branch) — eliminating broken-mainline incidents and unblocking developer velocity org-wide.
- Added metrics-driven reporting on pipeline health and developer productivity, making bottlenecks visible and driving continuous improvement across the developer workflow.

Prosper Marketplace — Lead DevOps Engineer · Jan 2015 – Dec 2016

- Rolled out org-wide CI/CD with Jenkins and containerization with Docker; managed microservice versioning (Artifactory) and static-analysis code quality (SonarQube) on AWS.

Pivotal Software — Member of Technical Staff · Sep 2011 – Jan 2015

- Managed CI infrastructure; migrated Perforce to Git; automated static analysis and code-coverage; built dynamic provisioning of Linux development/test environments on AWS and vCloud.

OPEN SOURCE

UniClaw · github.com/uniclaw-labs/uniclaw

- Architected and shipped UniClaw, an open-source AI agent platform for connected vehicle control — a multi-provider framework supporting 27+ vehicle brands (Tesla, BMW, Ford, Rivian) with natural language commands via 12 messaging channels (WhatsApp, Telegram, Slack) and voice assistants (Alexa, Google Home), built on Claude-powered agents, a FastAPI (Python) backend, and a Tauri desktop app in React 19 and TypeScript.
- Designed a security-first architecture for sensitive vehicle credentials: an OAuth2 authorization server with scoped JWTs, automatic Fernet encryption of secrets, constant-time token validation, and non-root containers.
- Delivered production-grade quality across a polyglot codebase (Python, TypeScript, Rust): 4,400+ automated tests, pluggable provider/channel adapters, Dockerized multi-service orchestration, and three AI backends (Anthropic API, local Ollama, zero-cost command mode).

EDUCATION

- M.S., Software Engineering, San Jose State University (2011)
- B.E., Computer Engineering, Gujarat University (2009)

SKILLS & TOOLS

- **AI Applications & Agent Engineering:** Production AI agents & applications (GCP ADK); agent architecture & agentic workflows; retrieval/RAG; MCP servers & integrations (incl. published open-source server); AI-assisted development (Cursor, Claude Code, GitHub Copilot); enterprise LLM rollout (Gemini Enterprise)
- **Backend & Architecture:** Python; API design; distributed systems & large-scale data services; retrieval pipelines; Kubernetes; scalable, reliable services (99.99%); observability (Grafana LGTM / OpenObserve, PagerDuty) & SLOs
- **Engineering Leadership:** Hiring, growing & retaining engineers; leading high-performing teams in high-growth startups; code & architecture reviews; fast, high-quality decisions; cross-functional partnership (Product, Design, AI); roadmaps & OKRs
- **Delivery & Quality:** CI/CD (GitHub Actions, Jenkins, Bazel, Gradle); test automation & pipeline gating (Robot Framework, Python); performance engineering (Locust)
- **Software & Data:** Python; Java/C/C#; Shell; MySQL, PostgreSQL, Oracle, DynamoDB